SS-B-681b
December 22, 1965

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. SS-B-00681a (GSA-FSS)
September 11, 1963 and
Fed. Spec. SS-B-681
June 28, 1932

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BRICK, BUILDING, SAND-LIME

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers common sand-lime brick of solid and hollow construction.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Grades.* The sand-lime brick shall be of the following grades as specified (see 6.2):

SW—Severe weather.
MW—Moderate weather.
NW—Nonweather.

2. APPLICATION SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640—Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-L-10547—Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147—Palletized Unit Loads 40″ × 48″ 4-Way Partial and 4-Way Pallets).

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(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply:

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Publications:

C 67—Methods of Sampling and Testing Brick.

C 73—Specification for Sand-Lime Building Brick.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pa., 19103.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Each grade of brick shall meet the requirements of ASTM C 73.

3.2 Size. The size of the brick shall be as specified (see 6.2 and 6.3).

3.3 Color and texture. The color and texture of the brick shall be as commercially produced.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any other commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling. The lot size and sample bricks required for visual examination, dimensional characteristics, and test shall be in accordance with ASTM C 67.

4.3 Test. Bricks shall be tested in accordance with ASTM C 67.

4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery. The packing and marking of the brick shall be inspected to determine conformance with the applicable requirements of section 5. The packing and marking requirements of section 5 identified to referenced specifications and standards shall be inspected in accordance with applicable referenced specifications and standards. The packing requirements of section 5 not identified to referenced specifications shall be examined for defects listed in table I in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective.

TABLE I. *Classification of defects*

Examine	Defect	Major
Packing	Cushioning not provided when required	X
	Fiberboard boxes not waterproof sealed with tape as specified	X
	Case liners not provided	X
	Wood boxes not modified by the addition of skids as specified	X
	Closure and strapping not as specified	X
	Strapping not zinc coated when applicable	X
	Pallets not provided when specified	X

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement, the definitions and application of levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.)

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.*

5.1.1.1 *Grade SW brick.* Grade SW brick shall be palletized in accordance with MIL-STD-147 for type VII load.

5.1.1.2 *Grades MW and NW brick.* Grades MW and NW brick shall be packed in fiberboard, triple-wall fiberboard, nailed and lock-corner wood, or cleated plywood wood

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boxes conforming to PPP-B-636 (class weather-resistant), PPP-B-640 (class 2, grade A), PPP-B-621 (class 2) and PPP-B-601 (overseas type), respectively. Cushioning shall be used to fill all voids to insure a compact fit. Fiberboard boxes shall be waterproof sealed in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification. Wood boxes shall be lined with sealed case liners conforming to MIL-L-10547 and the appendix thereto. Wood boxes exceeding 250 pounds gross weight shall be modified by the addition of not less than two nominal 2- by 4-inch wood skids. The skids shall then be attached by nails which shall be driven from the inside of the box while the skids are positioned flat across the bottom of the box, flush with the outside edges. Ends of the skids shall be beveled full depth at a 45° angle. Boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable box specification except that flat steel strapping shall be type I, class B.

5.1.2 *Level B.* The brick shall be packed as specified for level A except that boxes shall be domestic type or class as applicable, waterproof sealing and case liner requirements do not apply and flat steel strapping requirements need not apply.

5.1.3 *Level C.* Level C packing of the subject commodity shall be substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate to the point of delivery.

5.1.4 *Palletization.* When specified (see 6.2), the packed brick shall be palletized in accordance with MIL-STD-147 for type I load.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 *Civil agencies.* Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), shipping containers shall be marked with the name of the material, class, size, and shape, and quantity contained therein as defined by the contract or order under which shipment is made, the name of the contractor, and the number of the contract or order, and gross weight in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 *Military activities.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.

6.1.1 *Grade SW.* Brick intended for use where exposed to temperature below freezing in the presence of moisture.

6.1.2 *Grade MW.* Brick intended for use where exposed to temperature below freezing but unlikely to be saturated with water.

6.1.3 *Grade NW.* Brick intended for use as back-up or interior masonry exposed, for use where no frost action occurs where the average annual precipitation is less than 15 inches.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Grade of brick desired (1.2.1).
(*c*) Size of brick desired (3.2 and 6.3)
(*d*) Color and texture of brick if different from 3.3.
(*e*) Level of packing required (5.1).
(*f*) If palletizing is required (5.1.4).
(*g*) Marking if different from 5.2.

6.3 Sizes. For a list of modular sizes, see American Standard Sizes of Clay and Concrete Modular Masonry Units, A62.3. All of the sizes listed in this standard are not produced in some parts of the United States and purchasers should ascertain the size or sizes available.

6.4 Supersession data for grades.

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This specification	SS-B-681
Grade SW	Hard
Grade MW	Medium
Grade NW	Soft

6.5 Transportation descriptions. The transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Brick, building, common.
Carload minimum weight 60,000 pounds.

Motor:

Brick, building, common.
Truckload minimum weight 60,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army—MO (ERDL)
Navy—YD
Air Force—69

Review Activities:

Army—MO
Navy—YD
Air Force—69

User Interest:

Army—MO, MU
Navy—CG

Military coordinating activity—Army—MO

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